



### List of Reference Documentation

Psychological Operations Information System (PSYOPSIS), c. 3/1970 – 2/1973  
NN3-349-79-003  
Records of the U.S. Forces in Southeast Asia (Record Group 472)

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| Headquarters Military Assistance Command Vietnam [MACV], <i>Command Manual for Psychological Operations Information System (PSYOPSIS)</i> , MACV Document No. DAR V06 [or U06], 26 June 1970 | 52              |
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#### Supplemental Documentation (available upon request)

- Duplicate copies of: Headquarters Military Assistance Command, Vietnam, *Command Manual for Psychological Operations Information System (PSYOPSIS)*, MACV Document No. DAR V06 [or U06], 26 June 1970
- *System Design Review Document for Psychological Operations Information System (PSYOPSIS)*, DAR U06, c. 1970
- Psychological Operations Information System (PSYOPSIS) Maintenance Manual
- Miscellaneous documents seemingly relating to PSYOPSIS system design
- Correspondence and working papers relating to the development of PSYOPSIS
- Operations Manual for the Psychological Operations Information System, 30 June 1970
- PSYOPSIS Program Maintenance Manual, March 1970 (oversized)
- NARA-prepared draft documentation and sample dumps for PSYOPSIS NIPS files
- NARA processing materials for PSYOPSIS ASCII rendered files
- NIPSTRAN generated layouts for PSYOPSIS ASCII rendered files
- NIPSTRAN reports for ASCII rendered files
- NIPSTRAN program user manual



**USER NOTE**  
**Psychological Operations Information System (PSYOPSIS), 3/1970 – 2/1973**  
**Records of the U.S. Forces in Southeast Asia**  
**Record Group 472**

**NN3-349-79-003**

**Introduction**

The Psychological Operations Information System (PSYOPSIS) contains records about psychological operations carried out by the U.S. military during the Vietnam War. It contains data on ground and aerial psychological operations such as dropping leaflets and surface psychological operations such as loudspeaker broadcasts and radio transmissions. This data served as input for the Psychological Operation Quarterly Analysis System (PSYOPQA) where it was aggregated by quarter and linked with selected data from the Hamlet Evaluation System (HES).

PSYOPSIS consists of two data files, PSYOPSA and SORTIEA. The SORTIEA file contains information about aerial activity associated with psychological operations, including the date of the operation, aircraft type used, flight hours, and quantity of leaflets, newspapers, and magazines dropped. The PSYOPSA file contains information concerning surface activity, radio and television transmission, and demographic statistics collected on a district level. The records include the date of the operation, target audience, quantity of leaflets, posters and publications distributed, loudspeaker, and radio broadcast hours, television transmission hours, and demographics of the audience.

The MACVJ3-11 Psychological Operations Division created and maintained these files to provide operational data on psychological operations conducted during the Vietnam War. It allowed them to monitor and analyze psychological operations, improve the management of available resources, and increase the effectiveness of psychological operations. The files were used to produce weekly and monthly reports.

NARA received one transfer of the PSYOPSIS files in 1979. The Department of Defense transferred the files in the National Military Command System Information Processing System (NIPS). The transfer included agency documentation that provides the record format and structure for the NIPS PSYOPSIS files. The details of the files are as follows:

| <b>XMIS</b> | <b>File Name</b>  | <b>Bytes</b> | <b>Date Span</b> |
|-------------|-------------------|--------------|------------------|
| 012154      | RG349.PSY.M70TF73 | 693,522      | 3/1970-2/1973    |
| 012155      | RG349.SOR.M70TF73 | 3,823,386    | 3/1970-2/1973    |

The PSYOPSA data files contain one fixed set and two periodic sets. PSYOPSA data sets include counts of the hours of different types of television and radio broadcasts (news, entertainment and propaganda), the number of days various teams, such as the armed propaganda team and the civic action team spent in the field, populations of civilians and the Viet Cong and North Vietnamese army, and counts of the number of radios and televisions. The PSYOPSA data sets are all arranged by geographic location, specifically a district in South Vietnam. There is one record for each reporting period.

The SORTIEA data files contain one fixed set and one periodic set. SORTIEA data focuses on leaflet and other publication drops from airplanes and loudspeaker hours used in psychological operations. The fixed data set is arranged by date, while the periodic set is arranged by geographic location, specifically a district in South Vietnam. There is one record for each sortie flown.

See the "National Military Command System Information Processing System (NIPS)" insert included with this user note for more information on the NIPS format.

### **File Translation Process**

Vietnam NIPS ASCII Rendered Files Project. In 2007 a new software program, NIPSTRAN Version 3.4.1.0 was implemented to translate NIPS files into more usable ASCII Rendered Table Data Files. The NIPSTRAN program developed by NARA's Electronic Records and Special Media Division provides a tool to both analyze and extract into relations tables the data content of NIPS System backup or dump tapes. The NIPS file must be unaltered from the original which includes the record lengths as the first data in each record.

NIPSTRAN generates one Report File and one Layout File. The Report File details metadata found in the NIPS file and generates a listing of the data fields in each table. The Report also lists the size and number of records of each table in the NIPS file. The Layout File of the NIPS file is generated as an HTML file that contains the labels and full names of each data field in the file as well as information about that label from both the metadata of the NIPS file. The first column identifies the starting position for each record. The next column identifies from where the information is being drawn (NIPS Metadata). Then the next column is the length of the stored value. Since this is always ASCII, the stored length is always the external or display length. This is followed by the data type, and then who defined the label if the information was extracted from the NIPS file.

NIPSTRAN can generate a delimited file (comma or tab) for each table in the NIPS file. NIPSTRAN outputs each table representing each "Set," both the Fixed Set and the Periodic Sets, as separate files. The first row of each delimited file includes the field labels. If a label is preceded with a special symbol, I.E. a plus sign, then the delimited output of the first row has a single blank or space character preceding that label. This allows programs like Microsoft Excel to treat the label as textual information and not a mathematical operation. These files were verified using the Archival Electronic Records Inspection and Control (AERIC).

See NIPSTRAN Program Users Guide, Version 3.4.1.0, for more information.

ASCII Conversion Program. The PSYOPSIS NIPS files were converted by NIPSTRAN into 5 ASCII Rendered Table Data Files, one for each set or table in the NIPS file. The data files include 5 files in comma delimited format. NIPSTRAN also generated 2 layout files in HTML format.

| NIPS Files        |         | ASCII Rendered Files |                   |         |           |                 |
|-------------------|---------|----------------------|-------------------|---------|-----------|-----------------|
| File Name         | Records | XMIS                 | File Name         | Records | Bytes     | Type            |
| RG349.PSY.M70TF73 | 7,280   | 092372               | PSY.M70TF73.ARFS  | 319     | 34,902    | Comma Delimited |
|                   |         | 092373               | PSY.M70TF73.ARPS1 | 6,882   | 599,271   | Comma Delimited |
|                   |         | 092374               | PSY.M70TF73.ARPS2 | 79      | 3,961     | Comma Delimited |
|                   |         | 092375               | PSY.M70TF73.ARLAY | 1       | 41,991    | HTML            |
| RG349.SOR.M70TF73 | 60,508  | 092376               | SOR.M70TF73.ARFS  | 15,987  | 799,425   | Comma Delimited |
|                   |         | 092377               | SOR.M70TF73.ARPS1 | 44,521  | 3,383,742 | Comma Delimited |
|                   |         | 092378               | SOR.M70TF73.ARLAY | 1       | 23,257    | HTML            |

### **Agency Documentation**

Record Layout. There are NARA-prepared layouts for the ASCII rendered PSYOPSIS files, for both the fixed and periodic sets. Staff created these layouts using the information found in the original agency documentation. In addition to the NARA-prepared layouts, the 2 HTML layouts generated by NIPSTRAN were preserved and are available with the data files.

Code List. There are agency code lists for the PSYOPSIS files included in the agency documentation.

### **V. Data and Documentation**

Staff verified the comma-delimited ASCII rendered files using the Automated Electronic Records Inspection and Control (AERIC) System. Some discrepancies between the data and the documentation were noted during the verification process as described below.

#### **PSYOPSA Periodic Set 1 (PSY.M70TF73.ARPS1)**

During verification staff found that some values in data elements LEAFLET, SPRHRS, APT, CVC, RDC, and VIS exceed the expected field lengths as described in the corresponding layout. Staff reviewed records in the NIPS file and found that the values correspond to the agency layout. It is possible these discrepancies may be due to how the numeric values are stored in the original NIPS file. Staff confirmed that these discrepancies do not impact the use of the file, as the fields are appropriately delimited by the comma (,) character.

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Prepared: August 6, 2019



### **National Military Command System Information Processing System (NIPS)**

**Overview.** The National Military Command System Information Processing System 360 Formatted File System, commonly referred to as NIPS or NIPS 360 FFS, was developed in the 1960's under contract with the International Business Machines Corporation (IBM). It was a data management system which was operational on IBM System / 360 and System / 370 computers. NIPS provided data management support to structure files, generate and maintain files, revise and update files and data, select and retrieve data, and generate reports. NIPS used an IBM generalized file management system known at IBM as the Formatted File System (FFS). Originally implemented on the IBM 1410 computer, NIPS was primarily run on the IBM System 360 and was used for a variety of data related to the Vietnam War.

**NIPS Format.** Each NIPS file is organized into variable-length records, blocked and spanned. Although the bulk of the file is data, the beginning of the file consists of supporting information used during file maintenance, data retrieval, and output processing, such as the security classification record, data file control records, element format (field definitions) records, and file maintenance logic statement records. The sixth character of each logical record (following the four-character logical record length indicator and a system character) in the data file is used as a code indicating the type of information in that record (B = classification record, C = data file control record, F = element format record, L = file maintenance logic statement record, and R = data records).

A NIPS database consists of data elements organized into "Sets." The current view of these sets would be tables as all records, or rows, in these sets have the same format. Unfortunately, the historical documentation never refers to individual rows in these tables as records. The meaning of records in the historical documentation was logical assemblies of various rows from all the sets. Regardless of the terminology, the results are the same.

A NIPS database has one table (referred to as the Fixed Set) and multiple additional tables (referred to as Periodic Sets). There is a unique "key" in each row of the Fixed set which points to none to many rows in each Periodic Sets. The key is called the Control Set (an ambiguity since "Set" now has multiple meanings, I.E. a table and a key). This represents a one-to-many relationship and provides a hierarchical relationship of one and only one level.

Each row in a periodic set has none-to-many occurrences of the Control Set (key). A Subset (yet another use of the word set) is appended to the Control set (key) and represents a unique row in each periodic set (Table).

NIPS Documentation. Additional documentation on the NIPS format includes the "National Military Command System Information Processing System 360 Formatted File System (NIPS 360 FFS)" software manuals (Washington, DC: National Military Command System Support Center, Defense Communications Agency, 1971-73 editions; Washington, DC: Command and Control Technical Center, Defense Communications Agency, 1978 editions); filed with documentation for the Combat Air Summary File (OPREA), RG 218, NN3-218-76-025. Manuals (1971-74, with changes). It is also available through regional depository libraries and NARA RG 287 at SUDOC D 5.109.

Electronic Records Division, Reference Branch (RDER)  
Date: September 6, 2018

**Psychological Operations Information System (PSYOPSIS), SORTIEA**

| NARA-Prepared Layout for ASCII Rendered Fixed Set |             |              |            |         |                                                                                                                                                        |                                        |
|---------------------------------------------------|-------------|--------------|------------|---------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Field Name                                        | Field Order | Field Length | Data Type  | Use     | Field Title/Description                                                                                                                                | Notes                                  |
| DATE                                              | 1           | 6            | Alphameric | Control | Date of sortie                                                                                                                                         | Expressed as Year, Month, Day (YYMMDD) |
| CONDUCT                                           | 2           | 1            | Alphameric | Control | Organization which flew the sortie                                                                                                                     |                                        |
| UNIT                                              | 3           | 3            | Alphameric | Control | Unit conducting the operation                                                                                                                          |                                        |
| AIRCRAFT                                          | 4           | 6            | Alphameric | Control | Type of aircraft involved in operation                                                                                                                 |                                        |
| SEQNO                                             | 5           | 3            | Alphameric | Control | Unique record identifier assigned by MACV J311                                                                                                         |                                        |
| +PCN                                              | 6           | 3            | Alphameric |         | Periodic set number                                                                                                                                    | Created by the NIPSTRAN program        |
| +SC0                                              | 7           | 4            | Alphameric |         | Subset control group in the key for a specific logical record                                                                                          | Created by the NIPSTRAN program        |
| VSZ                                               | 8           | 4            | Numeric    |         | Indicates number of characters in the logical record's variable field; the field will contain zeros if there is no variable field for a logical record | Created by the NIPSTRAN program        |
| FHOURS                                            | 9           | 4            | Alphameric |         | Flight hours is the amount of time the sortie was in the air                                                                                           |                                        |

**Psychological Operations Information System (PSYOPSIS), SORTIEA**

**NARA-Prepared Layout for ASCII Rendered Periodic Set 1**

| Field Name | Field Order | Field Length | Data Type    | Use     | Field Title/Description                                           | Notes                                  |
|------------|-------------|--------------|--------------|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| DATE       | 1           | 6            | Alphanumeric | Control | Date of sortie                                                    | Expressed as Year, Month, Day (YYMMDD) |
| CONDUCT    | 2           | 1            | Alphanumeric | Control | Organization which flew the sortie                                |                                        |
| UNIT       | 3           | 3            | Alphanumeric | Control | Unit conducting the operation                                     |                                        |
| AIRCRAFT   | 4           | 6            | Alphanumeric | Control | Type of aircraft involved in operation                            |                                        |
| SEQNO      | 5           | 3            | Alphanumeric | Control | Unique record identifier assigned by MACV J311                    |                                        |
| +PCN       | 6           | 3            | Alphanumeric |         | Periodic set number                                               | Created by the NIPSTRAN program        |
| USID       | 7           | 5            | Alphanumeric | Control | District in South Vietnam where operation was conducted           | See agency documentation for code list |
| OPCODE     | 8           | 1            | Alphanumeric |         | Type of operation                                                 |                                        |
| CAMP       | 9           | 1            | Alphanumeric |         | Campaign code indicates type of campaign                          |                                        |
| THEME      | 10          | 2            | Alphanumeric |         | Theme of the psychological operation                              |                                        |
| STHEME     | 11          | 1            | Alphanumeric |         | Sub-Theme of the psychological operation                          |                                        |
| LEAFTRG    | 12          | 3            | Numeric      |         | Number of leaflet targets for a psychological operation           |                                        |
| LEAFNUM    | 13          | 5            | Numeric      |         | Amount of leaflets dropped during an operation                    |                                        |
| LOUDTRG    | 14          | 3            | Numeric      |         | Number of targets in a psychological loudspeaker operation        |                                        |
| LOUDHRS    | 15          | 3            | Numeric      |         | Amount of loudspeaker hours used in an operation                  |                                        |
| NEWS       | 16          | 3            | Numeric      |         | Number of newspapers and magazines dropped in an operation        |                                        |
| PUBL       | 17          | 3            | Numeric      |         | Amount of other publications dropped in a psychological operation |                                        |



**Psychological Operations Information System (PSYOPSIS), PSYOPSA**

| NARA-Prepared Layout for ASCII Rendered Fixed Set |             |              |              |         |                                                                                                                                                        |                                        |
|---------------------------------------------------|-------------|--------------|--------------|---------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Field Name                                        | Field Order | Field Length | Data Type    | Use     | Field Title/Description                                                                                                                                | Notes                                  |
| USID                                              | 1           | 5            | Alphanumeric | Control | Identifies a district in South Vietnam                                                                                                                 | See agency documentation for code list |
| +PCN                                              | 2           | 3            | Alphanumeric |         | Periodic set number                                                                                                                                    | Created by the NIPSTRAN program        |
| +SCO                                              | 3           | 4            | Alphanumeric |         | Subset control group in the key for a specific logical record                                                                                          | Created by the NIPSTRAN program        |
| VSZ                                               | 4           | 4            | Alphanumeric |         | Indicates number of characters in the logical record's variable field; the field will contain zeros if there is no variable field for a logical record | Created by the NIPSTRAN program        |
| POP                                               | 5           | 7            | Numeric      |         | Number of people residing in a particular district                                                                                                     |                                        |
| GVNPOP                                            | 6           | 7            | Numeric      |         | Number of people residing in a district that are loyal to the government of the Republic of Vietnam                                                    |                                        |
| HOICHN                                            | 7           | 5            | Numeric      |         | Hoi Chanh Received indicates the number of ralliers to the government of Vietnam in a district                                                         |                                        |
| REF                                               | 8           | 6            | Numeric      |         | Number of refugees in a district                                                                                                                       |                                        |
| NVA                                               | 9           | 6            | Numeric      |         | Number of North Vietnamese Army personnel in a district                                                                                                |                                        |
| VCHAM                                             | 10          | 6            | Numeric      |         | Number of Viet Cong guerrillas in a district                                                                                                           |                                        |
| VCI                                               | 11          | 6            | Numeric      |         | Viet Cong Infrastructure                                                                                                                               |                                        |
| SAS                                               | 12          | 4            | Numeric      |         | Security Average Score indicates the level of security in a district                                                                                   |                                        |
| DAS                                               | 13          | 4            | Numeric      |         | Development Average Score indicates the level of development in a district                                                                             |                                        |
| PAS                                               | 14          | 4            | Numeric      |         | Political Average Score indicates the level of political activity in a village                                                                         |                                        |
| NUMRAD                                            | 15          | 5            | Numeric      |         | Number of radios in a district                                                                                                                         |                                        |
| NUMTV                                             | 16          | 5            | Numeric      |         | Number of television receivers in a district                                                                                                           |                                        |

**Psychological Operations Information System (PSYOPSIS), PSYOPSA**

| <b>NARA-Prepared Layout for ASCII Rendered Periodic Set 1</b> |                    |                     |                  |            |                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                             |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|---------------------|------------------|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Field Name</b>                                             | <b>Field Order</b> | <b>Field Length</b> | <b>Data Type</b> | <b>Use</b> | <b>Field Title/Description</b>                                                                                                                         | <b>Notes</b>                                                                |
| USID                                                          | 1                  | 5                   | Alphameric       | Control    | Identifies a district in South Vietnam                                                                                                                 | See agency documentation for code list                                      |
| +PCN                                                          | 2                  | 3                   | Alphameric       |            | Periodic set number                                                                                                                                    | Created by the NIPSTRAN program                                             |
| DATE1                                                         | 3                  | 6                   | Alphameric       |            | Date on which surface activity was conducted                                                                                                           | Format is Year, Month, Day (YYMMDD)                                         |
| CONAG                                                         | 4                  | 1                   | Alphameric       |            | Conducting agency code indicates which organization performed the operation                                                                            |                                                                             |
| REPORT                                                        | 5                  | 3                   | Alphameric       |            | Unit conducting the operation                                                                                                                          |                                                                             |
| OP                                                            | 6                  | 1                   | Alphameric       |            | Specific type of operation                                                                                                                             |                                                                             |
| CAMPN                                                         | 7                  | 1                   | Alphameric       |            | Type of campaign                                                                                                                                       |                                                                             |
| THEM                                                          | 8                  | 2                   | Alphameric       |            | Type of theme                                                                                                                                          |                                                                             |
| STHEM                                                         | 9                  | 1                   | Alphameric       |            | Sub-theme of the operation                                                                                                                             |                                                                             |
| VSZ1                                                          | 10                 | 4                   | Alphameric       |            | Indicates number of characters in the logical record's variable field; the field will contain zeros if there is no variable field for a logical record | Created by the NIPSTRAN program                                             |
| LEAFLET                                                       | 11                 | 4*                  | Numeric          |            | Number of leaflets passed out during an operation                                                                                                      | *Values in the ASCII rendered file may exceed this. See the NARA user note. |
| SPRHRS                                                        | 12                 | 3                   | Numeric          |            | Number of hours broadcast over a loudspeaker during a psychological operation                                                                          |                                                                             |
| POSTERS                                                       | 13                 | 3                   | Numeric          |            | Amount of posters and handbills passed out or posted during an operation                                                                               |                                                                             |
| PUBLS                                                         | 14                 | 3                   | Numeric          |            | Other publications passed out during an operation                                                                                                      |                                                                             |
| APT                                                           | 15                 | 2*                  | Numeric          |            | Number of days spent in the field by an armed propaganda team                                                                                          | *Values in the ASCII rendered file may exceed this. See the NARA user note. |

**NARA-Prepared Layout for ASCII Rendered Periodic Set 1**

| <b>Field Name</b> | <b>Field Order</b> | <b>Field Length</b> | <b>Data Type</b> | <b>Use</b> | <b>Field Title/Description</b>                                             | <b>Notes</b>                                                                |
|-------------------|--------------------|---------------------|------------------|------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| CAP               | 16                 | 2                   | Numeric          |            | Number of days spent in the field by a combined action platoon             |                                                                             |
| CDT               | 17                 | 2                   | Numeric          |            | Number of days spent in the field by a culture drama team                  |                                                                             |
| CVC               | 18                 | 2*                  | Numeric          |            | Number of days spent in the field by a civic action team                   | *Values in the ASCII rendered file may exceed this. See the NARA user note. |
| HB                | 19                 | 2                   | Numeric          |            | Number of days spent in the field by a combat loudspeaker team             |                                                                             |
| HE                | 20                 | 2                   | Numeric          |            | Number of days spent in the field by an audio visual team                  |                                                                             |
| MDC               | 21                 | 2                   | Numeric          |            | Number of days spent in the field by a medcap/denticapt team               |                                                                             |
| RDC               | 22                 | 2*                  | Numeric          |            | Number of days spent in the field by a rural development cadre team        | *Values in the ASCII rendered file may exceed this. See the NARA user note. |
| SLT               | 23                 | 2                   | Numeric          |            | Number of days spent in the field by a support liaison team                |                                                                             |
| VIS               | 24                 | 2*                  | Numeric          |            | Number of days spent in the field by a Vietnamese information service team | *Values in the ASCII rendered file may exceed this. See the NARA user note. |
| AUD               | 25                 | 1                   | Alphameric       |            | Target audience is the type of people at which the operation was directed  |                                                                             |

**Psychological Operations Information System (PSYOPSIS), PSYOPSA**

**NARA-Prepared Layout for ASCII Rendered Periodic Set 2**

| <b>Field Name</b> | <b>Field Order</b> | <b>Field Length</b> | <b>Data Type</b> | <b>Use</b> | <b>Field Title/Description</b>                                                                                                                         | <b>Notes</b>                           |
|-------------------|--------------------|---------------------|------------------|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| USID              | 1                  | 5                   | Alphanumeric     | Control    | Identifies a district in South Vietnam                                                                                                                 | See agency documentation for code list |
| +PCN              | 2                  | 3                   | Alphanumeric     |            | Periodic set number                                                                                                                                    | Created by the NIPSTRAN program        |
| DATE2             | 3                  | 4                   | Alphanumeric     |            | Date of the radio/tv transmission                                                                                                                      | Format is Year, Month (YYMM)           |
| REPUNIT           | 4                  | 3                   | Alphanumeric     |            | Unit conducting the operation                                                                                                                          |                                        |
| VSZ2              | 5                  | 4                   | Alphanumeric     |            | Indicates number of characters in the logical record's variable field; the field will contain zeros if there is no variable field for a logical record | Created by the NIPSTRAN program        |
| RNEWS             | 6                  | 3                   | Numeric          |            | Number of broadcast hours used to present news on radio                                                                                                |                                        |
| RENT              | 7                  | 3                   | Numeric          |            | Number of broadcast hours used for entertainment on radio                                                                                              |                                        |
| RIP               | 8                  | 3                   | Numeric          |            | Number of broadcast hours used for information and propaganda on radio                                                                                 |                                        |
| TVNEWS            | 9                  | 3                   | Numeric          |            | Number of television transmission hours used to present news                                                                                           |                                        |
| TVENT             | 10                 | 3                   | Numeric          |            | Number of television transmission hours used for entertainment                                                                                         |                                        |
| TVIP              | 11                 | 3                   | Numeric          |            | Number of television transmission hours used for information and propaganda                                                                            |                                        |